Snow

Zoë Birtwhistle

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Singers

Every voice possesses its own peculiar colour, its own trajectory, its own appetite. Do not blend the voices into uniformity: let them collide, shimmer, and delight in their incompatibility.

The scoring and dynamics assume 16 singers, two to each stave. The minimum viable ensemble required to realise all divisi is 11 singers (four sopranos, two altos, two tenors and three basses).

Vibrato and portamento are occasionally indicated, but their use is not restricted to those passages. Expressive portamenti should be distinguished from the continuous, deliberate glissandi at Figure D and in the closing bars.

The tangerine should taste indecently vivid.

Piano

The piano part is optional. An a cappella performance is preferred, provided the choir can sustain the harmonic structure without instrumental support. The piano part may also be performed independently as a solo.

The piano part in the version of this song for solo mezzo-soprano and instrumental ensemble (clarinet, saxophone, piano, viola and double bass) differs substantially from the piano part printed here.

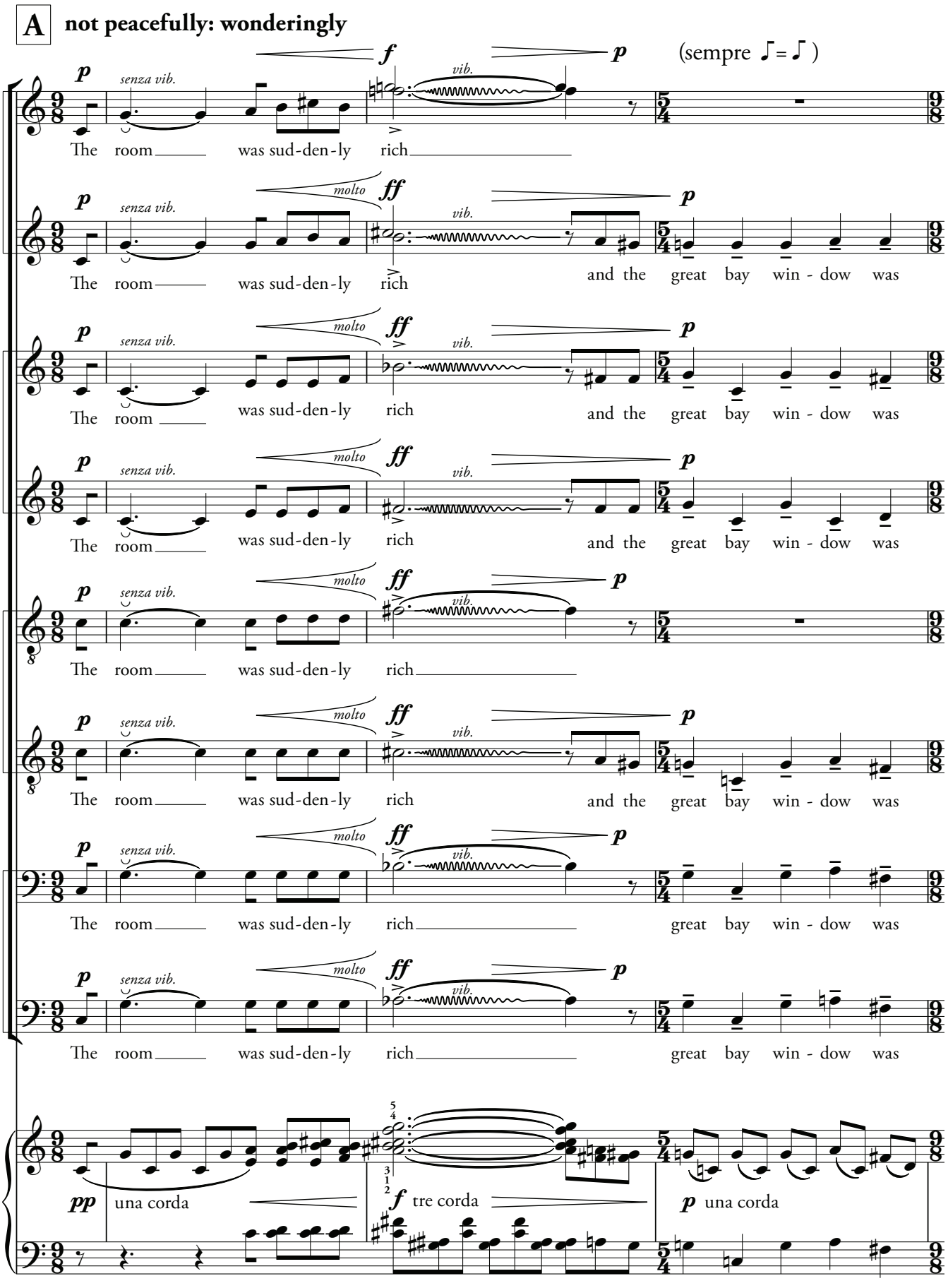
Damper pedal markings indicate specific points of use, but the pedal may be employed elsewhere at the pianist's discretion. Una corda should be used only where indicated.

Occasional fingerings are provided as suggestions; the pianist may substitute alternatives as appropriate.
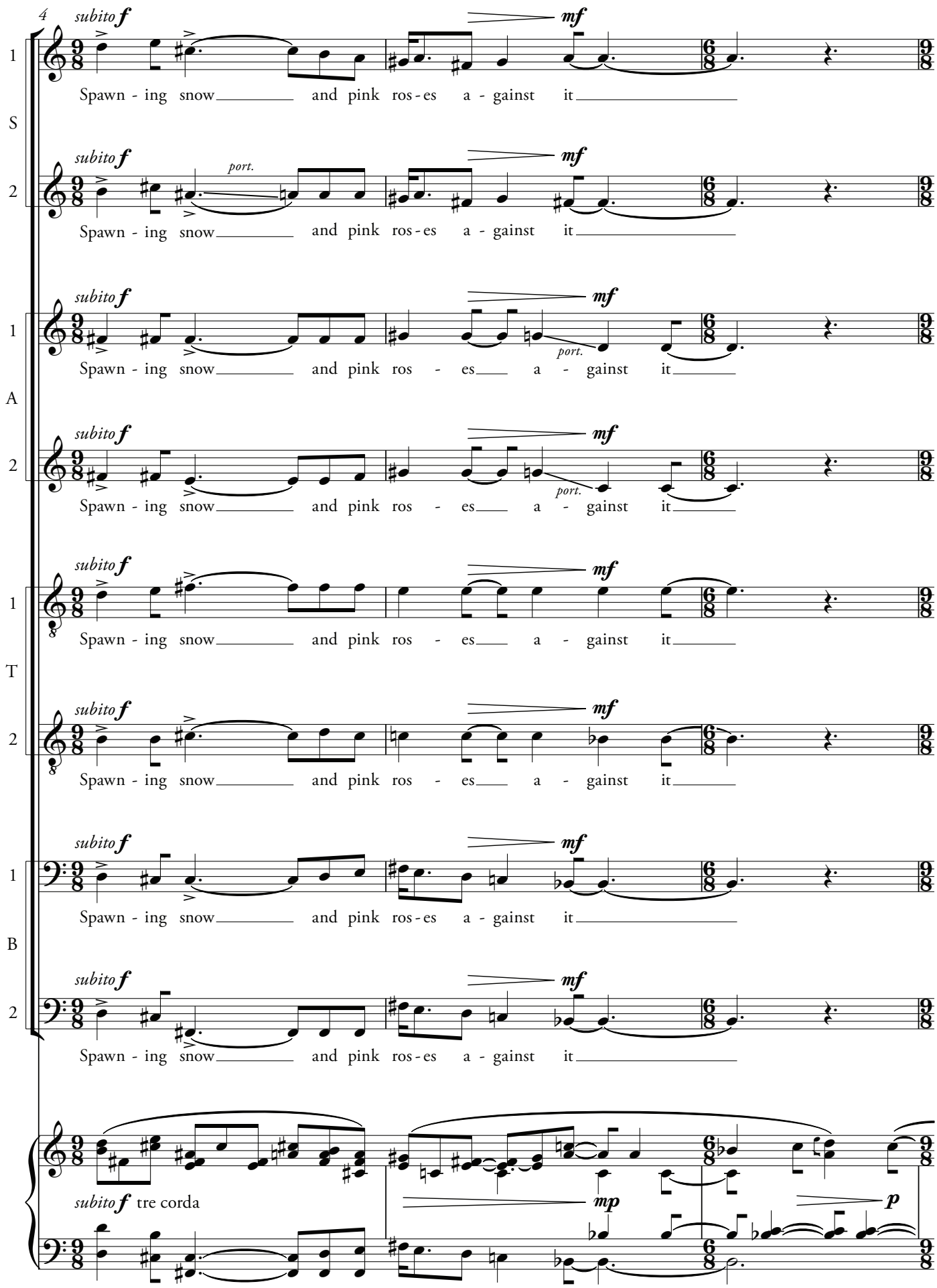
Snow
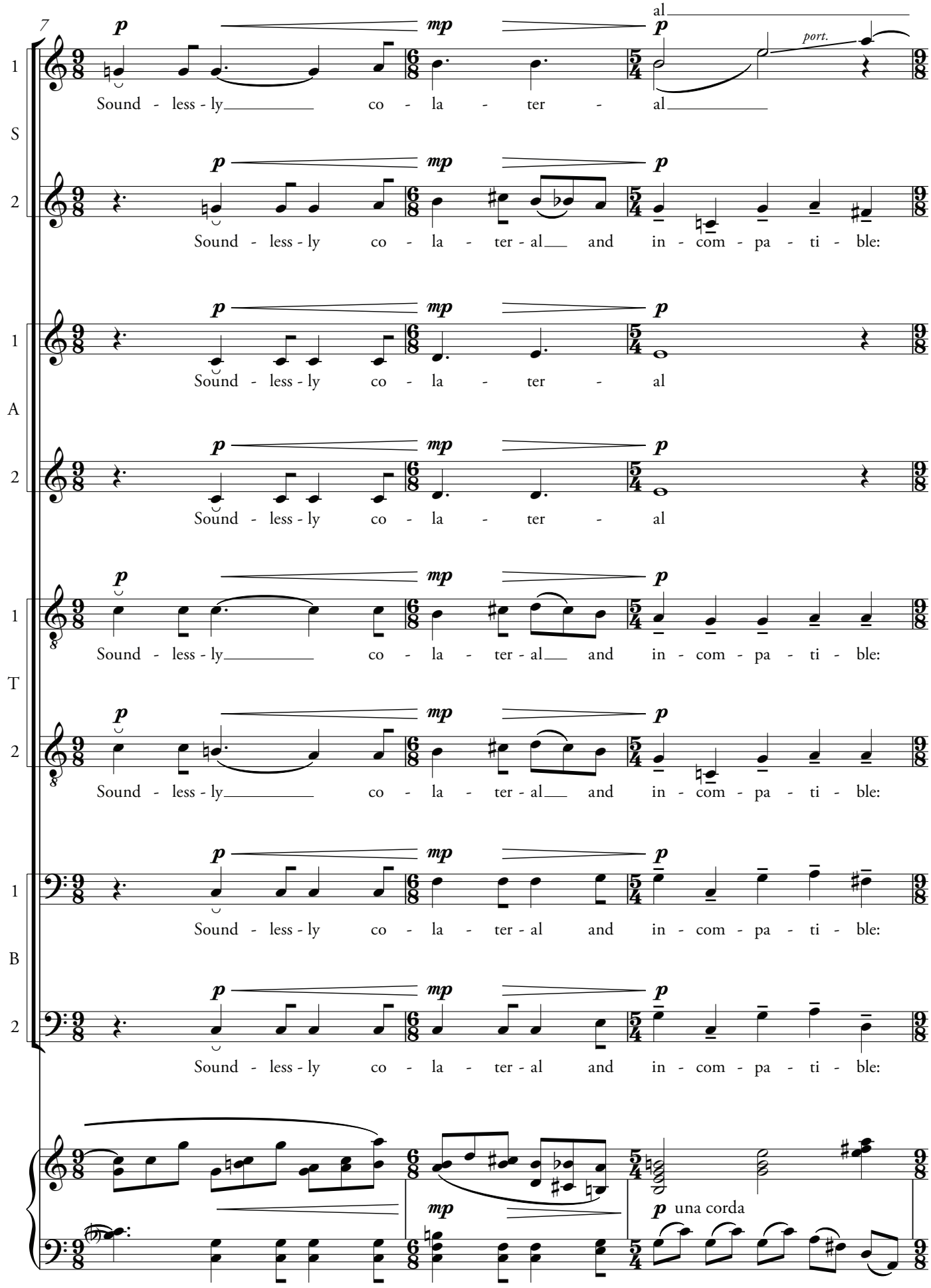
Louis MacNeice (1907 – 1963)
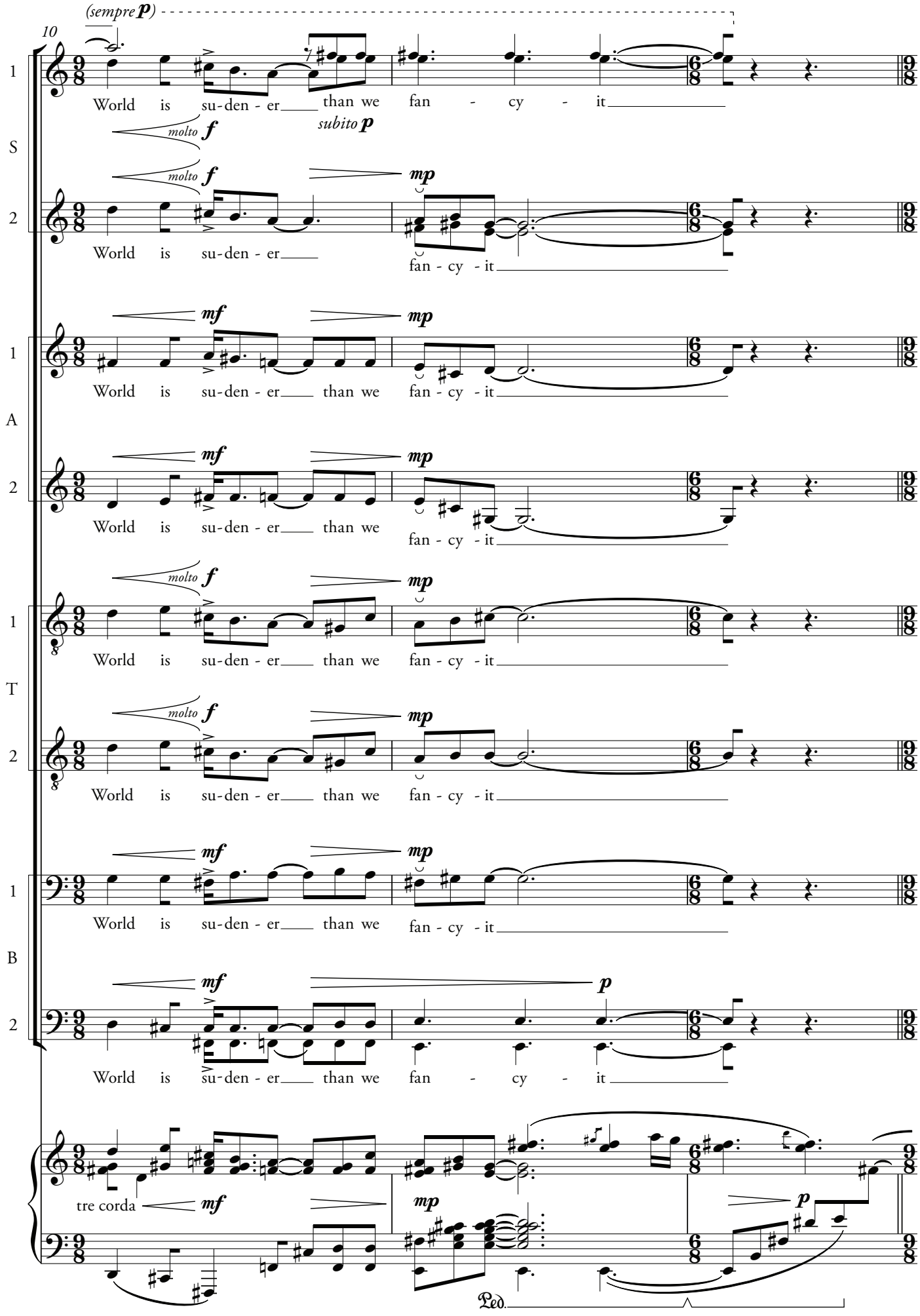
Zoë Birtwhistle
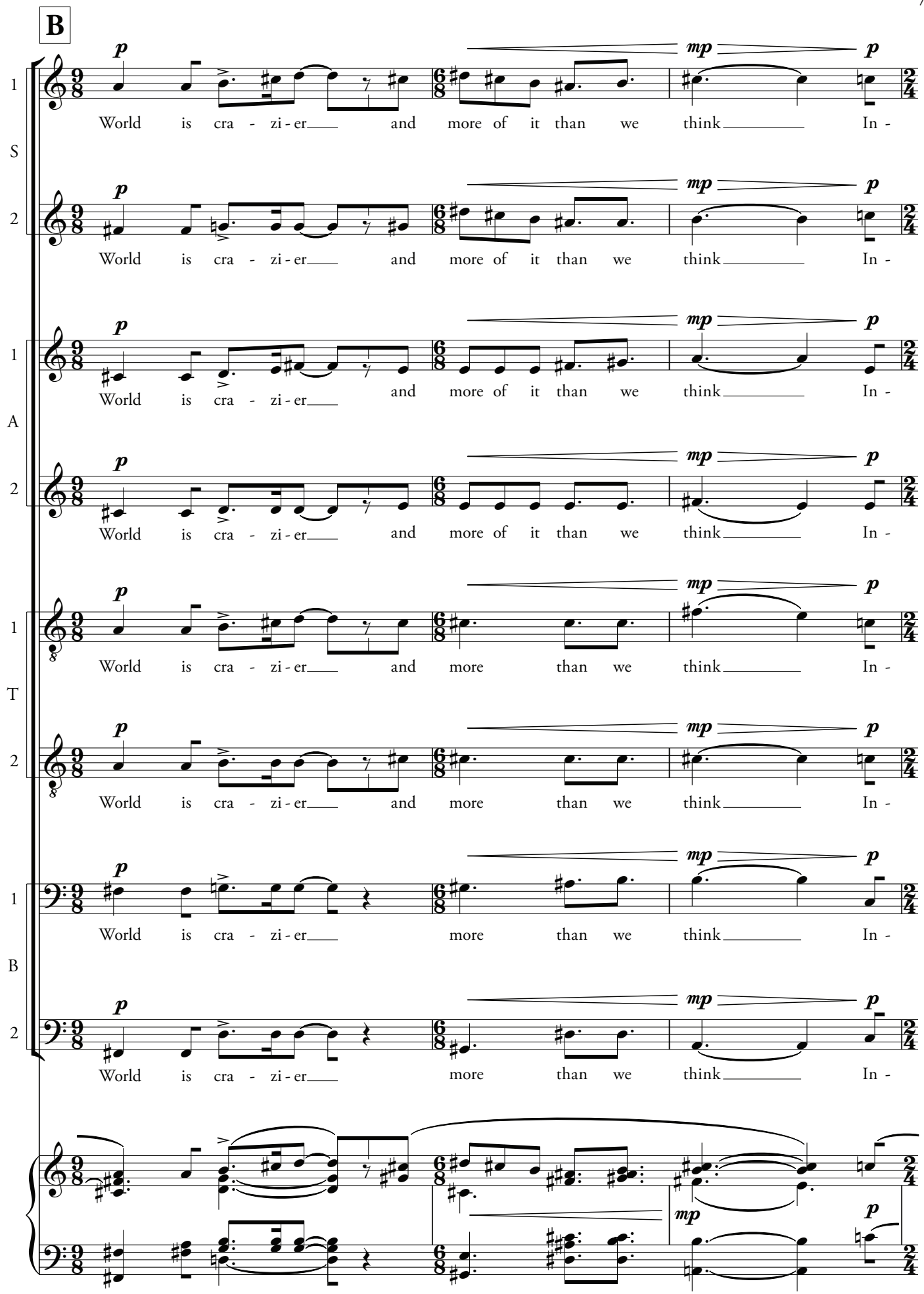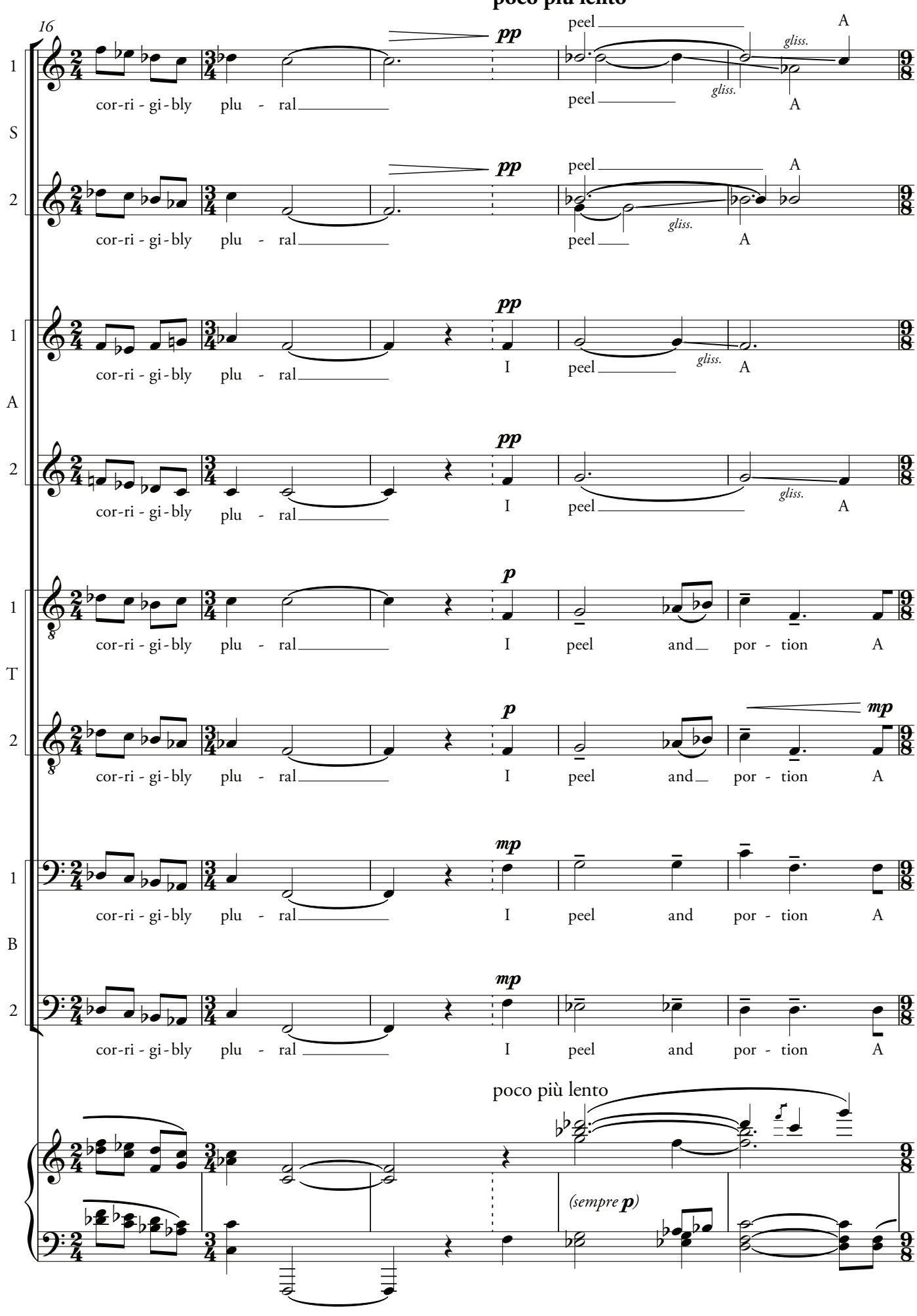


* optional; a capella preferred.
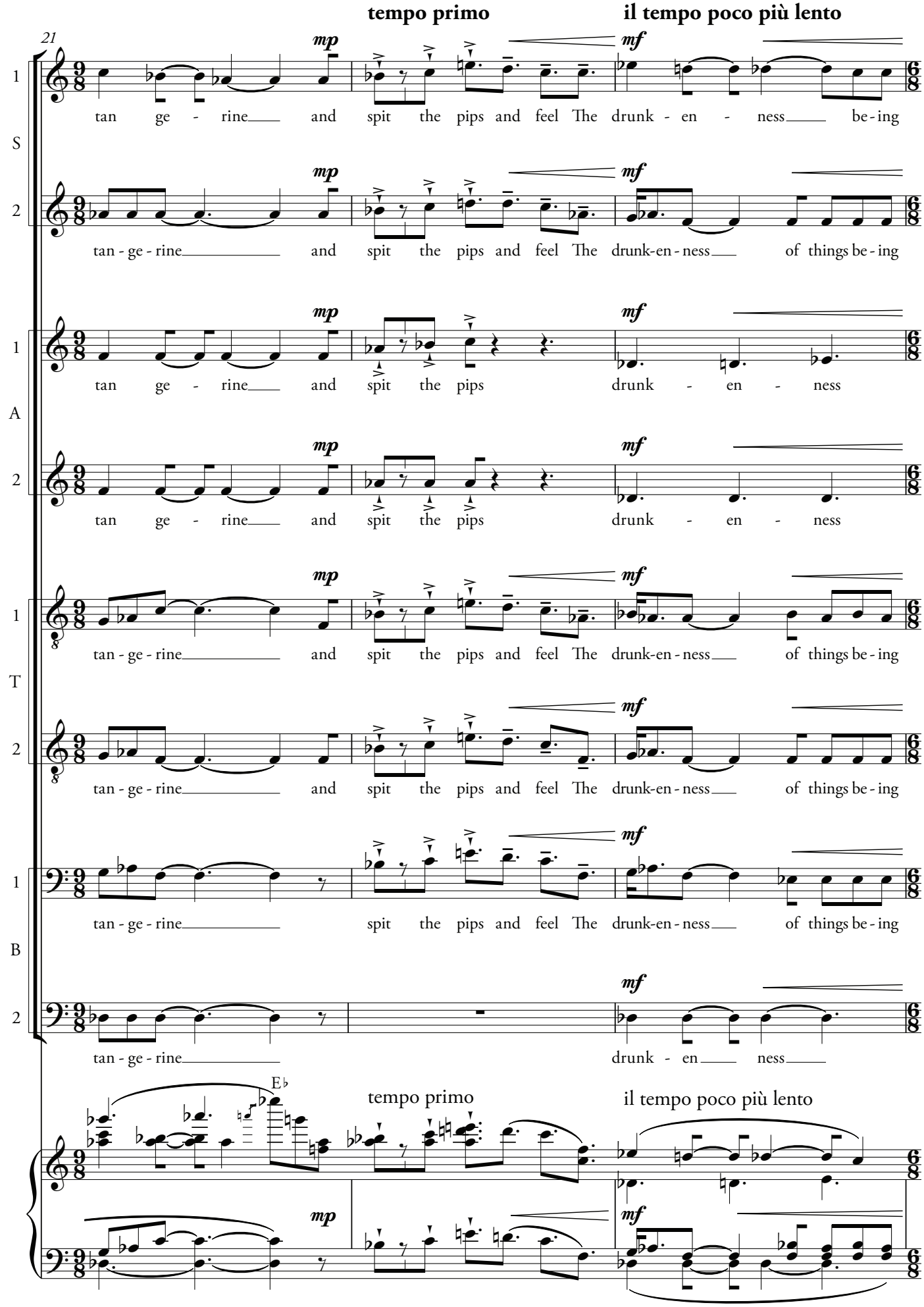

4
subito f
mf
1
S
Spawn - ing snow and pink ros - es a - gainst it
2
port.
A
T
B
tre corda
mp
p
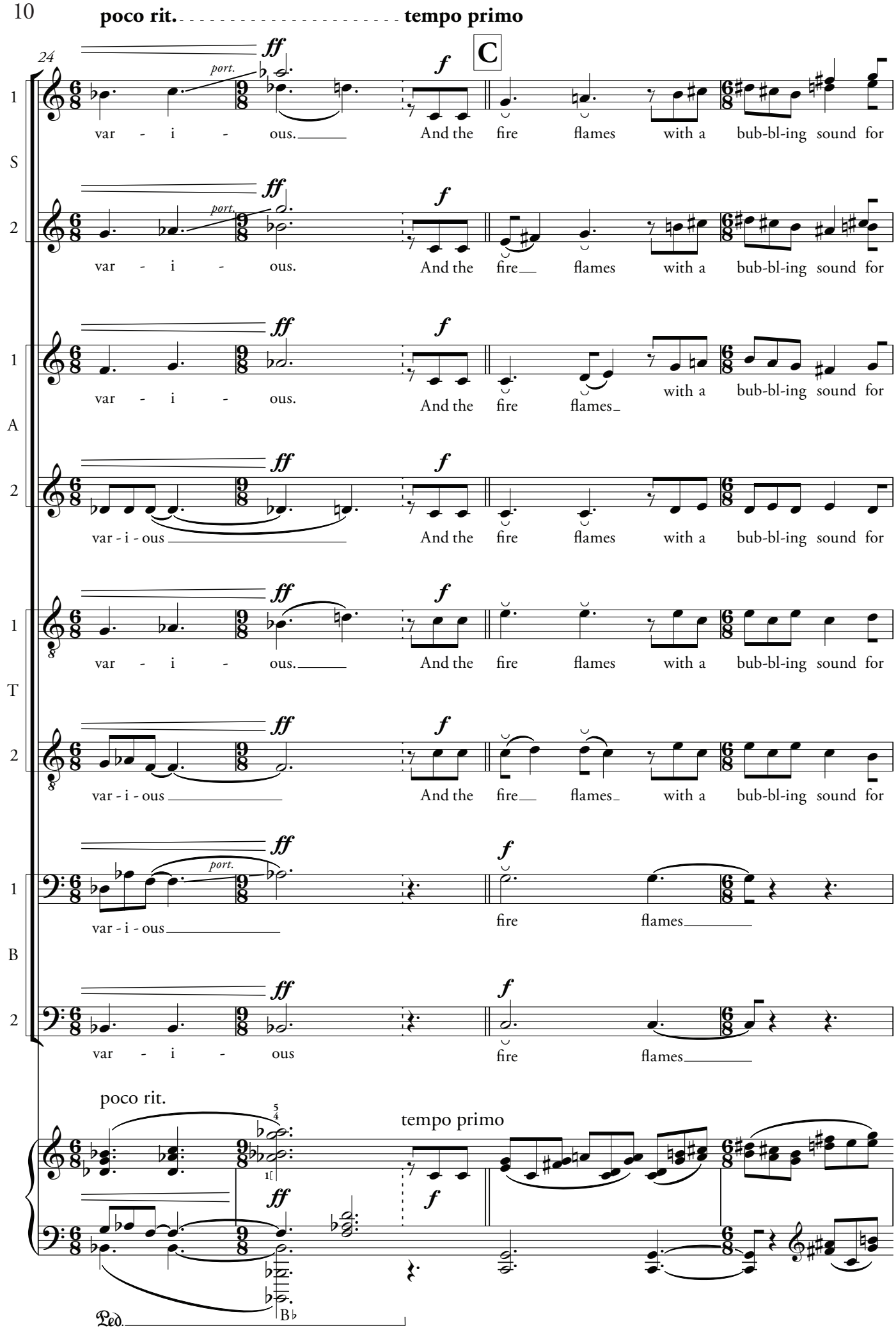

7
1
S
2
1
A
2
1
T
2
1
B
2
Sound - less - ly co - la - ter - al
Sound - less - ly co - la - ter - al and in - com - pa - ti - ble:
port.
una corda
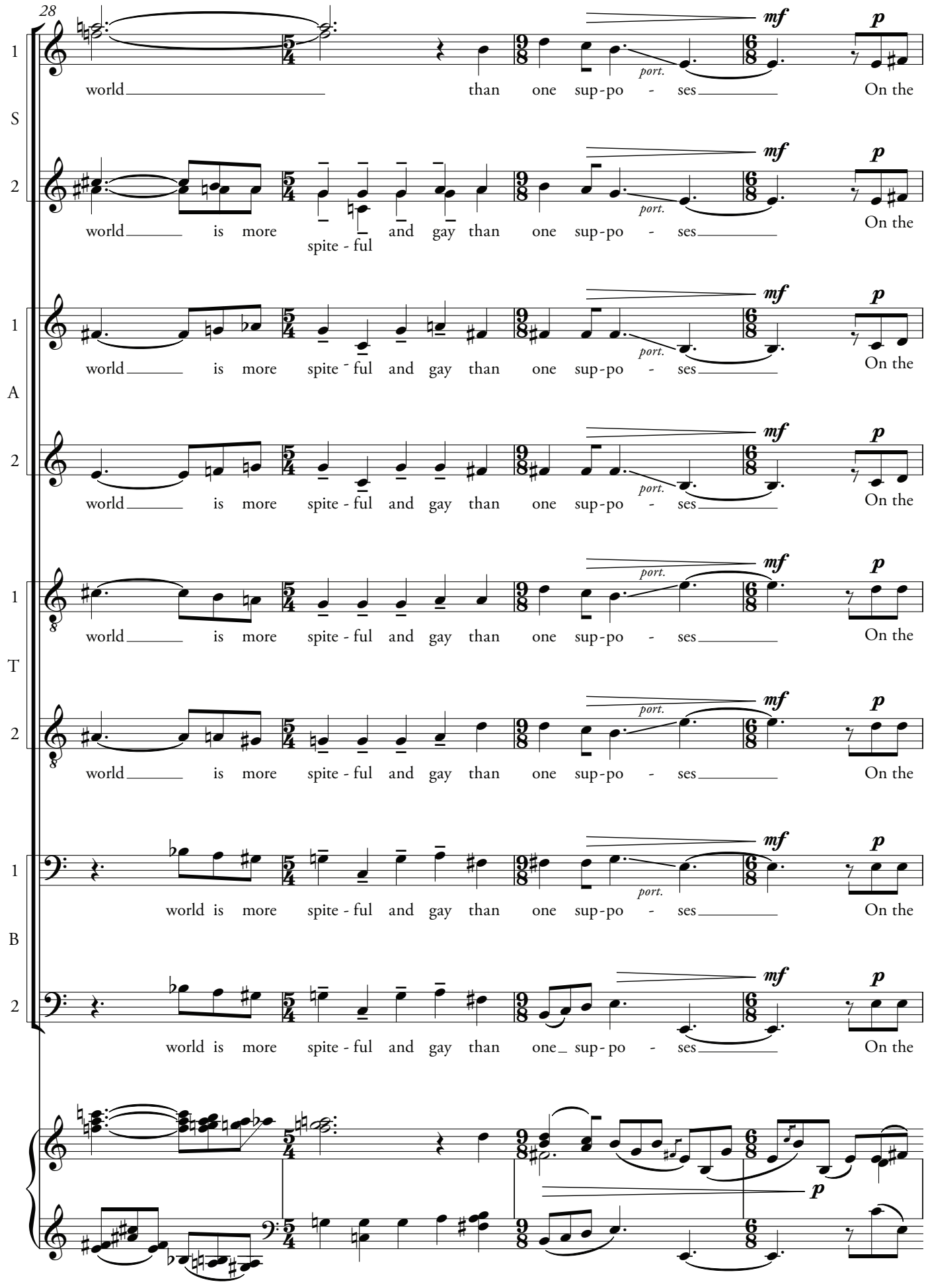

(sempre p)
10
1
S
World is su-den - er than we fan - cy - it
molto f
subito p
2
World is su-den - er
mp
fan - cy - it
A
mf
T
B
p
tre corda
Ped.
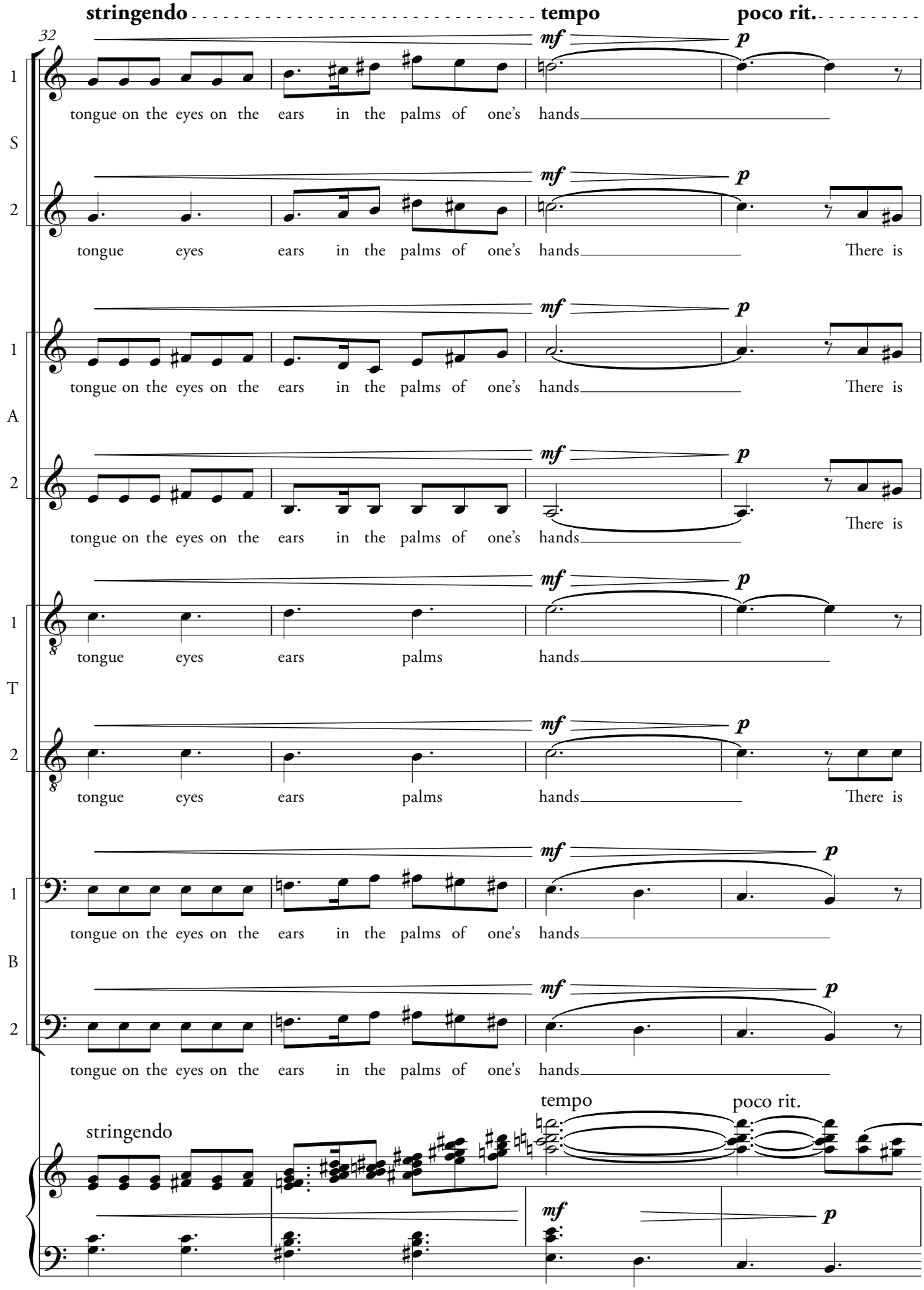

B
1
S
2
1
A
2
1
T
2
1
B
2
p
mp
p
World is cra - zi - er and more of it than we think In -
World is cra - zi - er and more than we think In -
World is cra - zi - er more than we think In -
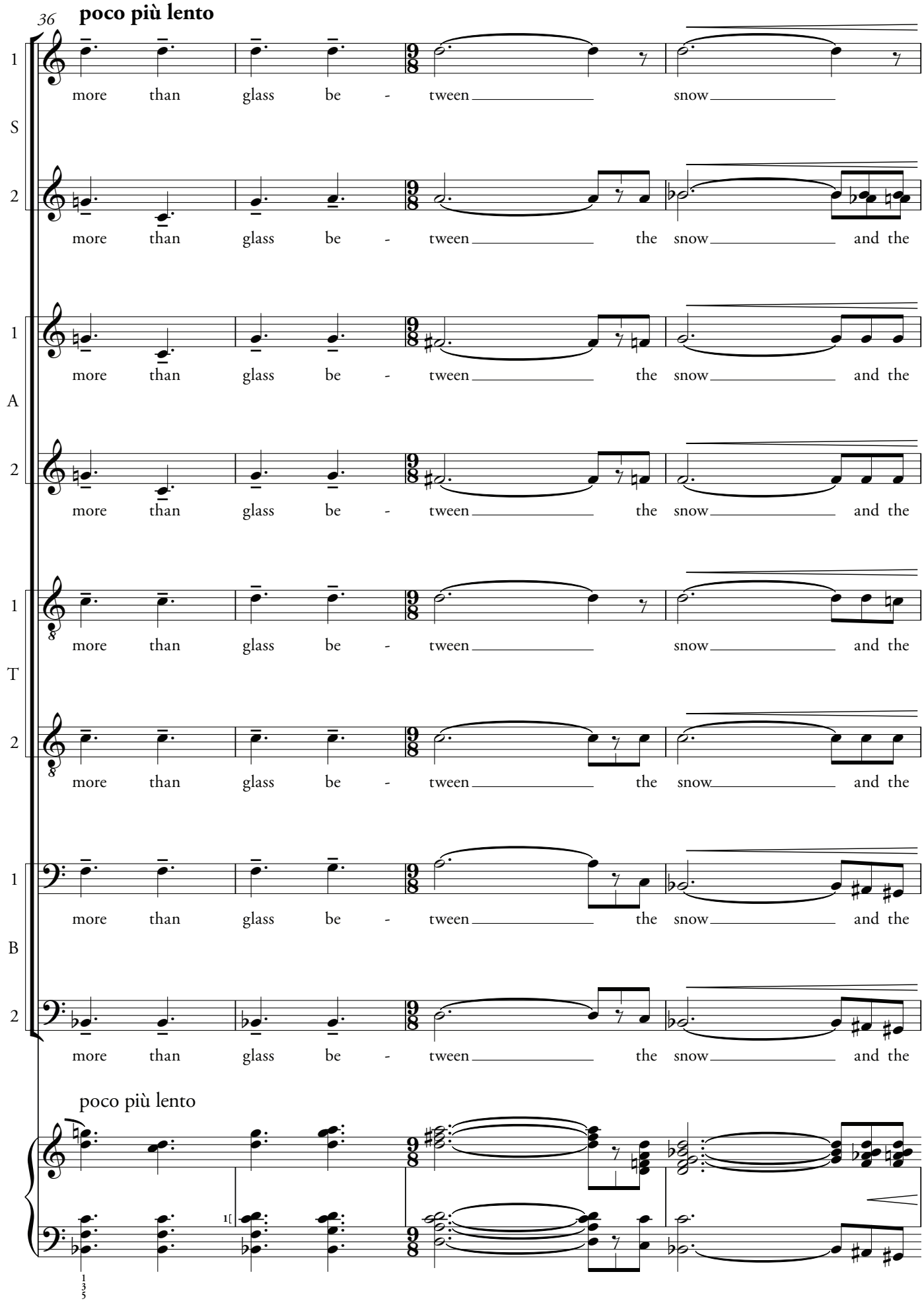

poco più lento
16
S
A
T
B
1
2
pp
p
mp
cor-ri-gi-bly plu-ral
peel
gliss.
A
I
and
por-tion
poco più lento
(sempre p)

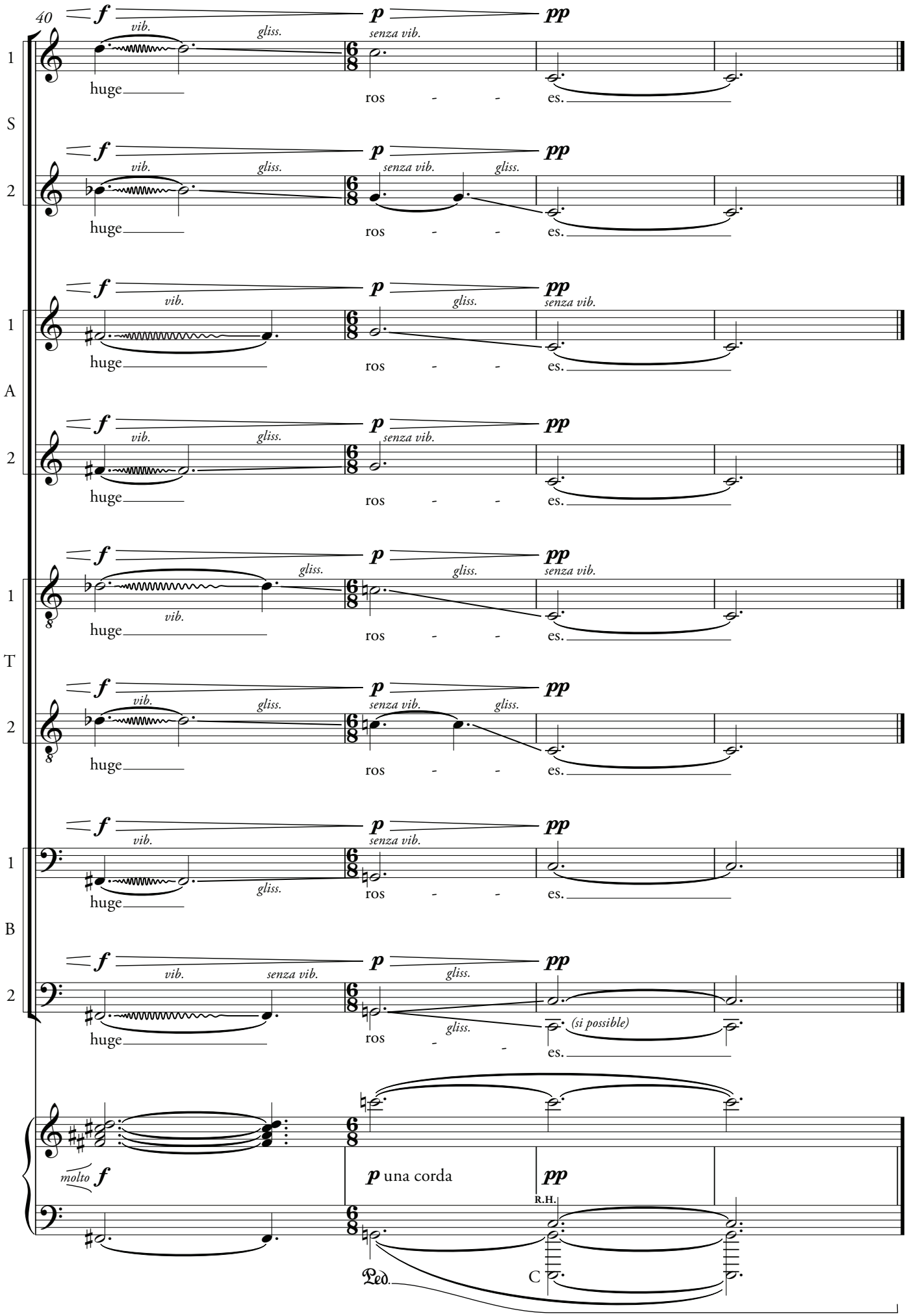

tempo primo
il tempo poco più lento
21
S
A
T
B
tan ge - rine and spit the pips and feel The drunk - en - ness be - ing
tan - ge - rine and spit the pips and feel The drunk-en - ness of things be - ing
tan ge - rine and spit the pips drunk - en - ness
tan - ge - rine spit the pips and feel The drunk-en - ness of things be - ing
tan - ge - rine drunk - en ness
E♭
tempo primo
il tempo poco più lento


poco rit.
tempo primo
24
C
port.
ff
f
1
S
2
A
T
B
var - i - ous.
And the fire flames with a bub-bl-ing sound for
var - i - ous
var - i - ous.
And the fire flames
with a bub-bl-ing sound for
var - i - ous
And the fire flames with a bub-bl-ing sound for
var - i - ous.
And the fire flames with a bub-bl-ing sound for
var - i - ous
And the fire flames with a bub-bl-ing sound for
var - i - ous
fire flames
var - i - ous
fire flames
poco rit.
tempo primo
Ped.


28
1
S
2
world than one sup-po - ses On the
world is more and gay than one sup-po - ses On the
spite - ful
1
A
2
world is more spite - ful and gay than one sup-po - ses On the
1
T
2
world is more spite - ful and gay than one sup-po - ses On the
1
B
2
world is more spite - ful and gay than one sup-po - ses On the
world is more spite - ful and gay than one sup-po - ses On the
mf
p
port.


stringendo
tempo
poco rit.
32
1
S
2
tongue on the eyes on the ears in the palms of one's hands
tongue eyes ears in the palms of one's hands There is
1
A
2
tongue on the eyes on the ears in the palms of one's hands There is
tongue on the eyes on the ears in the palms of one's hands There is
1
T
2
tongue eyes ears palms hands
tongue eyes ears palms hands There is
1
B
2
tongue on the eyes on the ears in the palms of one's hands
tongue on the eyes on the ears in the palms of one's hands
stringendo
tempo
poco rit.
mf
p


36
poco più lento
1
S
2
more than glass be - tween snow
more than glass be - tween the snow and the
1
A
2
more than glass be - tween the snow and the
more than glass be - tween the snow and the
1
T
2
more than glass be - tween snow and the
more than glass be - tween the snow and the
1
B
2
more than glass be - tween the snow and the
more than glass be - tween the snow and the
poco più lento
1[


40
f
vib.
gliss.
p
senza vib.
pp
1
S
2
huge
ros - -
es.
vib.
gliss.
senza vib.
1
A
2
1
T
2
1
B
2
(si possible)
molto f
p una corda
R.H.
Ped.
C